November 9, 2026 05:02 AM GMT

Software | North America

Assessing Data Center Exposure Following Midterm Results

Recent market dislocation on the back of Midterm results has driven a meaningful re-rating across our broader AI infrastructure coverage set, creating an attractive risk / reward in certain instances as overall data center exposure and near-term capacity risk screen reasonably limited.

Key Takeaways

- The post midterm selloff creates selective opportunities: demand is intact, with capacity risk more in Texas / Ohio in 2028 than 2027 where we see low risk.
- Microsoft's global footprint and fleet efficiencies cushion local permitting risks; our capex forecasts remain unchanged - would be our preferred play.
- Oracle's outlook allows for a couple of quarters of delays at four key sites, while smaller projects diversify delivery risk.
- CoreWeave and Nebius show limited near-term policy exposure, but Helios and Pennsylvania warrant monitoring; financing risks remain.
- DigitalOcean and Akamai face limited policy risk at existing sites, but limited disclosure on expansion locations leaves future exposure unclear.

Adding Another Layer of Uncertainty to the AI Infrastructure Build Out, but a Slower Build Out in 2028 Is Not Necessarily a Stock Price Negative. Recent Midterm elections have added a policy overhang to the broader AI infrastructure build out, heightening concerns around data center development timelines and opposition to existing and new projects (see US Public Policy: Midterm Election Results: Decisive for Democrats (4 Nov 2026)). In conjunction, AI infrastructure names under our coverages have traded down 12% over the past week and 28% over the trailing three month period (on average). Granted, the neoclouds have faced the greatest pressure amid renewed financing concerns, though policy uncertainty brings another layer of risk to the broader sector. While we acknowledge the potential disruption from a changing congressional agenda, the recent sell off appears to increasingly reflect these risks and data would suggest minimal risk to 2027 capacity plans with risk more concentrated to 2028 projects located in Texas and Ohio (see Communications Infrastructure: ~12 GW US Data Center Pipeline Through 2030 at Risk in Texas and Ohio (6 Nov 2026)). We would argue that a moderate slowing of the pace of expansion in 2028 is not necessarily a blanket negative for the stocks we cover. A continuing supply / demand imbalance would likely prove even more positive for pricing and companies may be able to give investors a clearer and better view of returns on their investments more quickly - a key debate in the market on this build out more broadly.

Microsoft Remains Our Preferred Play, Concerns Seem Overdone for Akamai and

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SOFTWARE

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Industry View **Attractive**

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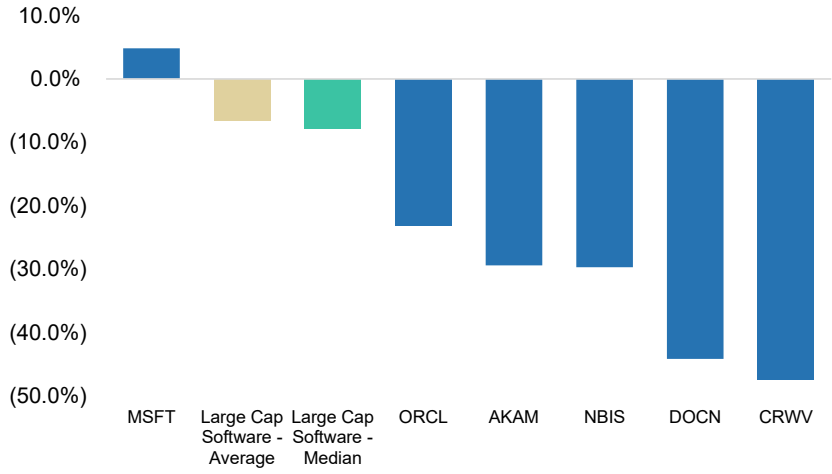
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DigitalOcean. To that point, at Microsoft, the scale of its global fleet, demonstrated efficiency gains, and geographic diversity of incoming capacity leave the company well positioned to manage potential Texas permitting constraints, supporting our unchanged capex forecasts. This remains our preferred way to play this opportunity. At Oracle, while several GW-scale U.S. projects carry delivery risk, management's latest guidance / multi-year outlook already embeds cushion for up to a 'couple quarters' of delays at four key sites, with a broader pipeline of smaller projects helping to mitigate risk to the overall build out. Risks also appear to screen reasonably limited across both CoreWeave and Nebius with the latter having no exposure to states where gubernatorial seats flipped and CoreWeave's projects largely complete or well on the path to completion in Texas and Georgia. The debate here being more financing than capacity focused at this point. At Akamai, management indicated on its 3Q26 earning call that it has secured all of the necessary co-location sites and power for its $11.6 billion mega deal with a large AI customer. DigitalOcean pursues a similar co-location strategy to Akamai that targets bringing megawatts of capacity online (incremental 75 / 30 megawatts set to come online / signed for 2027 and 2028) instead of gigawatts. As such, the recent reaction for both appears overdone, in our view.

Ultimately, our underlying demand view remains unchanged; demand signals remain sound, which supports the need for additional infrastructure, and the principal risk screens more towards a shift in deployment timing and allocation of capex, rather than a structural reduction in investment requirements.

Exhibit 1: Trailing Three-Month Stock Performance Across Our AI Infrastructure Coverage Set



Source: Company data, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research

Read-Throughs For Our AI Infrastructure Coverage:

Microsoft: Microsoft remains well positioned to navigate localized development constraints, supported by the scale of its fleet, demonstrated efficiency gains, and the geographic diversity of capacity coming online. Microsoft added >2GW in FY25 and ~1GW in F4Q26 alone, with installed capacity expected to grow from ~11GW in FY26 to >20GW by FY28. Within this buildout, the planned ~2GW Pecos campus and Crusoe's 672MW Abilene campus carry some Texas permitting sensitivity,

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although both have onsite generation and sit at different stages of development. Development exposure also extends beyond Texas, including projects in greater Atlanta, Georgia; central Ohio; Ginger West near Des Moines, Iowa; and Silver Springs, Nevada. Importantly, management's outlook already incorporates some third-party GPU capacity shifting into 2HFY27 while still guiding to 49–50% cc Azure growth in 2Q, with fleet efficiencies helping offset delayed deliveries. We think this demonstrates the value of Microsoft's broader infrastructure strategy – growth is supported not only by bringing new sites online, but also by increasing the productive capacity of the existing fleet. Nscale's deployments in Norway (~30K Rubin GPUs) and Portugal (~66K Rubin GPUs) further illustrate the breadth of supply coming on stream beyond the US states discussed. Together, this scale, operational flexibility, and diversified sourcing provide multiple levers to respond to evolving local requirements, including reprioritizing incremental deployments across the global pipeline, broadening third-party supply, and improving fleet utilization. While these alternatives do not eliminate project-level timing risk, we see Microsoft as well equipped to manage it and retain our CapEx estimates of ~$238B / ~$298B / ~$358B in FY27 / FY28 / FY29, with growth moderating from ~64% to ~25% and ~20%, respectively.

Oracle: During its recent Investor Day, Oracle indicated having ~1GW of capacity as of FY25 (May 2025), and ~3GW of capacity as of FY26 (May 2026). After delivering ~850MW in its most recent quarter, the company expects to bring another ~6GW of capacity online by FY28 – reaching a total 10GW of capacity. There are several marquee GW scale sites in the U.S. that account for ~5GW of capacity, slated for delivery between FY26 and mid-FY29 (i.e., not all within the FY28 target): Abilene (TX), Shackelford (TX), Dona Ana (NM), Saline Township (MI), Port Washington, (WI). Within the mix, Abilene is closest to completion, with the company having delivered ~75%/618MW of capacity as of 1Q27 (Aug '26), and describing the site as "nearing completion" at its October Investor Day. The remaining four sites are expected to start service at various points across calendar year 2027. While construction and delivery timelines remain an area of debate, the company has also indicated that its guidance embeds cushion for up to 'a couple of quarters' of delays at those four sites. Importantly, management sees these sites rolling out incrementally by data hall and building, with lease and CapEx commitments ramping alongside revenues – meaning in the event of a delay, costs would be delayed in tandem with minimal stranded capital, aided by hardware fungibility across sites and cost-plus contracts that protect margin. Additionally, there is a long tail of smaller sites contributing to the build out – implying a lower degree of risk relative to the five ~1GW-scale sites referenced above. Specifically, as of FY25, Oracle indicated that the 1GW of capacity spanned 109 regions, with the 10GW target contemplating expansion to ~230 regions (and would note that the 850MW of capacity delivered in 1FQ27 spanned ~38 data center projects across ~11 countries, only one of which was Abilene). From an investment perspective, underlying this ambition, the company sees a ~$220bn capex requirement to complete this portion of the build out in aggregate, though a substantially lower net investment (~50%) need as the company leverages vendor financing, customer pre-payment, and 'bring your own hardware' deal constructs.

CoreWeave: CoreWeave's data center footprint has exposure to Texas and Georgia

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primarily through sites in Denton, Texas (~260 MW), Austin, Texas (~20 MW), West Texas (~526 MW), and Dalton, Georgia (~175 MW). Most of these sites are largely operational, with the Austin, Texas site complete, the Denton, Texas site substantially complete, and Dalton, Georgia site expected to be completed in early 2027. However, it is worth monitoring the company's Helios data center site (via Galaxy Digital - covered by James Faucette) in West Texas given CoreWeave has committed to 526 MW of critical IT power at the site with Phase I (133 MW - critical IT) delivered in July and Phase II (260 MW - critical IT) expected to commence in 2Q27 and delivered throughout 2027 with the remainder commencing in 2028 (see Powered Shell Providers: Midterm Implications for the "Time to Power" Stocks (4 Nov 2026) for additional details). All in, risk seems to be relatively minimal as most of the company's existing sites located in states where governorship flipped are already operational. Moreover, management's commentary suggests an increase in regulatory scrutiny will not impact demand for AI infrastructure but rather where that infrastructure gets built – "*we believe that the certain communities have moved forward with moratoriums and we feel like moratoriums are – they're not going to impact the demand for this infrastructure. They are going to impact where this infrastructure gets built.*" To that point, the company has been expanding its international capacity footprint over the past several weeks with announcements including 1) bringing new capacity online in Denmark (~22.5 MW) and expanding points of presence across the UAE, India, Indonesia, Singapore, Australia, Korea, and Japan, 2) expanding into India via a 240 MW agreement in Navi Mumbai with AdaniConneX, and 3) expanding in Indonesia via a 360 MW agreement across three facilities expected to come online in 2028.

Nebius: Nebius operates or has contracted for capacity at multiple US data center sites, including >1 GW in Missouri, >1 GW in Pennsylvania, >100 MW in Alabama and New Jersey, with additional sites in Minnesota and Oklahoma. While Pennsylvania's governor announcing more strict guardrails around data center development introduces some uncertainty associated with the company's GW-scale site in the state, currently disclosed projects suggest the company does not appear to have exposure to states including Texas, Ohio, Nevada, Georgia, or Iowa – where gubernatorial control flipped. The company also maintains a meaningful operational and contracted capacity footprint internationally including Finland (>100 MW), France (>100 MW), Iceland, the UK, and Israel.

Akamai: Akamai currently has core Cloud Infrastructure Services data-center regions in Dallas, Texas and Atlanta, Georgia. Since these sites are already operational, regulatory and development risk across the existing footprint appears limited. More specifically, on its 3Q26 call, management indicated that it has secured all of the necessary co-location sites and power for its $11.6 billion mega deal with a large AI customer (as well as for its previously signed large deals). Execution on these signed contracts will power accelerating revenue growth through 2028. As such, the issue for Akamai, is securing compute capacity to drive growth in 2029 and beyond. The extenuating circumstance, is that Akamai pursues a decentralized compute strategy that focuses on adding a few megawatts of capacity across multiple colocation facilities (as opposed to centralized datacenters requiring gigawatts of capacity). As a result, we see limited risk if new facilities are located in s[illegible] gubernatorial control has flipped, although the risk is difficult to

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quantify given the limited disclosure. See Akamai Technologies, Inc.: Feedback After the Recent Stock Reaction — Growth to Accelerate But ROI Taking on Greater Focus (29 Sep 2026) for additional details.

DigitalOcean: DigitalOcean operates multiple US data center sites across Richmond, Virginia (6 MW), Kansas City, Missouri (10 MW), Memphis, Tennessee (15 MW), and Atlanta, Georgia. Given these sites are already active, regulatory and development risk across the existing footprint appears limited. The company has signed 75 MW of expansion capacity in 2027 (60 MW tied to four sites) that are not yet active and signed an additional 30 MW slated for 2028. Visibility into these sites is relatively limited, posing some level of risk should these sites be located in states where gubernatorial seats flipped.

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Risk Reward – Microsoft (MSFT.O)

Durability of Earnings Growth & AI Leadership Not Priced-In

PRICE TARGET $650.00

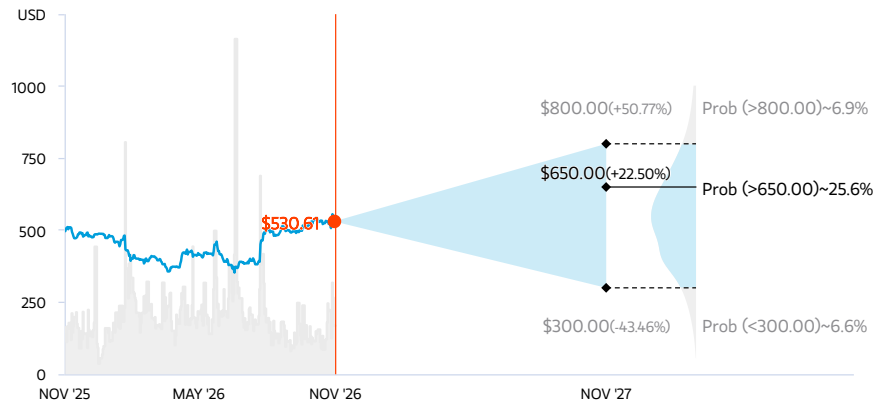
26x Base Case FY28e EPS of $24.71. 26x PE is a slight premium to large cap software peers, 1.3x PEG is a discount to MSFT historical PEG and large-cap software peers.

Consensus Price Target Distribution $440.00 — $629.72 (MS PT) — $870.00

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

◆ Mean ◆ Morgan Stanley Estimates

RISK REWARD CHART AND OPTIONS IMPLIED PROBABILITIES (12M)



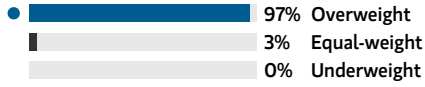
Key: Historical Stock Performance ● Current Stock Price ◆ Price Target

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OVERWEIGHT THESIS

- Greater than expected capacity-driven Azure growth inflection and Copilot monetization supports high-teens rev growth.
- Meaningful gross margin % headwinds are offset by operating leverage, yielding 20%+ EBIT growth and >20% EPS growth
- Shares trading at ~21x FY28 GAAP EPS too cheap. Overweight

Consensus Rating Distribution



● MS Rating

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward Themes

New Data Era:	*Positive*
Pricing Power:	*Positive*
Secular Growth:	*Positive*

View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes here

BULL CASE $800.00

~29x Bull Case FY28e EPS: $27.41

Azure, O365 & Robust Contribution from AI Drive Top-Line Growth. Acceleration in Azure growth, adoption of higher priced M365 Commercial SKUs and continued seat growth, and robust adoption of Azure AI services and Microsoft AI Copilots across business lines drive low-20s revenue CAGR in the coming years. Operating margins expand to ~49.0% by FY28 and FY28e EPS is $27.41. ~29x PE represents a premium to large cap software peers, but below MSFT historical avg PEG at ~1.2x given >20% EPS CAGR.

BASE CASE $650.00

~26x Base Case FY28e EPS of $24.71

Azure, M365 & Ramping Contribution from AI Drive Top-Line Growth. Durability of Azure growth, adoption of higher priced M365 Commercial SKUs and continued seat growth, and ramping adoption of Azure AI services & Microsoft AI Copilots across business lines drive high-teens rev CAGR ahead. Operating margins expand beyond ~46.7% by FY28 and FY28e EPS is ~$25. 26x PE is a premium to large cap software peers, given strong positioning and execution. 1.3x PEG is a discount to MSFT historical PEG.

BEAR CASE $300.00

~11x Bear Case FY28e EPS: $22.25

Macro, Scale & Limited AI Adoption Drives Top-Line Growth Deceleration. Azure growth continues deceleration given scale, while M365 reaches penetration and adoption of Azure AI services & Microsoft AI Copilots across business lines remains limited. This drives mid-teens rev CAGR. Operating margins only expand to ~45.0% by FY28 from gross margin pressure and FY28 EPS is ~$22. ~13x PE is a discount to large cap software peers and a discount on a PEG.

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Risk Reward – Microsoft (MSFT.O)

KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	Jun 2026	Jun 2027e	Jun 2028e	Jun 2029e
Azure and Other Cloud Services Growth (%)	40.7	44.9	43.2	41.2
M365 Commercial Cloud Growth (%)	16.4	17.4	17.4	17.6
Gross Margins (%)	67.9	65.9	64.5	63.5
Operating Margins (%)	46.8	46.6	46.7	47.2
GAAP EPS Growth (%)	31.5	10.7	22.9	25.8

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

- Sustainability of commercial cloud growth, Copilot growth
- Improving Azure growth, cloud momentum, improving cloud margins

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



- 0-10% APAC, ex Japan, Mainland China and India
- 0-10% India
- 0-10% Japan
- 0-10% Latin America
- 0-10% MEA
- 0-10% Mainland China
- 0-10% UK
- 10-20% Europe ex UK
- 50-60% North America

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies here

MS ALPHA MODELS

3/5 BEST	24 Month Horizon	1/5 MOST	3 Month Horizon

Source: Refinitiv, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research; 1 is the highest favored Quintile and 5 is the least favored Quintile

RISKS TO PT/RATING

RISKS TO UPSIDE

- Cloud adoption accelerates, with Azure as convincing winner
- AI leadership results in substantial revenue contribution over-time
- Operational efficiencies leading to greater than anticipated economies of scale and margin expansion

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

- Weak macro impacting IT spending
- On-premises cannibalization by Cloud
- Increased investments hurt margin expansion
- AI adoption proves limited

OWNERSHIP POSITIONING

Inst. Owners, % Active	52.4%
HF Sector Long/Short Ratio	2.2x
HF Sector Net Exposure	30.6%

Refinitiv; MSPB Content. Includes certain hedge fund exposures held with MSPB. Information may be inconsistent with or may not reflect broader market trends. Long/Short Ratio = Long Exposure / Short exposure. Sector % of Total Net Exposure = (For a particular sector: Long Exposure - Short Exposure) / (Across all sectors: Long Exposure – Short Exposure).

MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY Jun 2027e

Sales / Revenue ($, mm)
◆ 398,980
Note: There are not sufficient brokers supplying consensus data for this metric

EBITDA ($, mm)
◆ 241,216
Note: There are not sufficient brokers supplying consensus data for this metric

Net income ($, mm)
◆ 147,354
Note: There are not sufficient brokers supplying consensus data for this metric

EPS ($)
◆ 19.86
Note: There are not sufficient brokers supplying consensus data for this metric

◆ Mean ◆ Morgan Stanley Estimates

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

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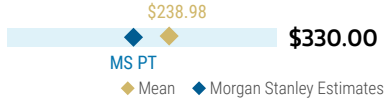
Risk Reward – Oracle Corporation (ORCL.N)

Big Opportunity, Little Room For Error

PRICE TARGET $210.00

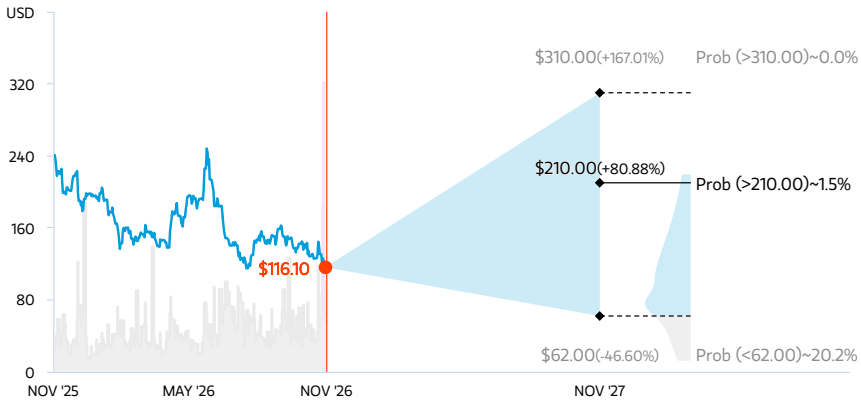
Derived from ~19x CY28e base case NGAAP EPS of $11.08. Our ~19x multiple a slight discount to ORCL's 5Y average (~20x), and larger discount on PEG (~0.9x, vs ~1.6x L5Y avg) given execution risk and lack of FCF support given GPUaaS investment.

Consensus Price Target Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

RISK REWARD CHART AND OPTIONS IMPLIED PROBABILITIES (12M)



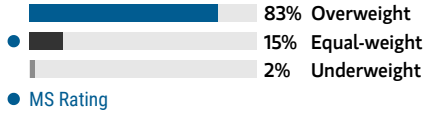
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EQUAL-WEIGHT THESIS

- Our assessment of the underlying drivers within Oracle's FY30 targets suggest a) acceleration is expected in other areas of the business (e.g. SaaS, core OCI) b) substantial operating leverage and c) favorable outcomes in financing its infrastructure build out.
- While robust RPO provides visibility towards achievement of $225 billion of FY30 revenue, magnitude and duration of GPUaaS investment cycle remain highly uncertain, as do longer term economics -- particularly given mounting balance sheet obligations.
- Given the importance of execution across numerous vectors, we see a balanced risk reward on shares at current levels.

Consensus Rating Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

BULL CASE $310.00

~23x FY30e NGAAP EPS of $16.05 (disc. back)

- FY30 revenue scales ~$204bn

- FY30 gross margins compress to ~47.5%, and operating margins compress to 39.2%, given mix shift towards GPUaaS

- Yields FY30 EPS of ~$16.05, reflecting ~21% 5Y CAGR, but undershoots ~$21 target

BASE CASE $210.00

~19x CY28e Base Case NGAAP EPS of $11.08

- CY28 revenue scales to ~$146bn, reflecting 38% CAGR (CY26-CY28)

- NGAAP gross margins compress to ~51%, operating margins compress to 39.7%, given mix shift towards GPUaaS

- Yields $111.08 CY28 EPS, reflecting ~22% CAGR (CY26 - CY28)

- 19x multiple discount to historical average (~20x), with larger discount implied by PEG (0.9x, vs L5Y ~1.6x) given execution risk and lack of FCF support given GPUaaS investment.

BEAR CASE $62.00

~15x FY28e Core (ex-GPUaaS) GAAP EPS of $4.16

Our Bear Case Core (ex-GPUaaS) EPS of $4.16 reflects our FY28 core earnings power, burdened by a) SBC and intangible amortization and b) 50% of our estimated FY28 lease expenses (implying that Oracle would be able to exit ~50% of existing lease agreements).

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Risk Reward – Oracle Corporation (ORCL.N)

KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	May 2026	May 2027e	May 2028e	May 2029e
Cloud Services and License Support YoY Growth (%)	22.2	43.0	44.3	42.4
Total Revenue YoY Growth (%)	17.4	34.2	37.4	37.7
Operating Margin % (%)	42.9	41.1	40.3	39.2
Earnings Per Share YoY Growth (%)	26.5	6.0	24.3	28.6

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

- Execution of GPUaaS build out
- Additional share repurchases
- Accretive acquisitions

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



- 0-10% APAC, ex Japan, Mainland China and India
- 0-10% India
- 0-10% Japan
- 0-10% MEA
- 0-10% UK
- 10-20% Europe ex UK
- 10-20% Latin America
- 50-60% North America

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies here

MS ALPHA MODELS

3/5 **BEST**	24 Month Horizon	3/5 **MOST**	3 Month Horizon

Source: Refinitiv, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research; 1 is the highest favored Quintile and 5 is the least favored Quintile

RISKS TO PT/RATING

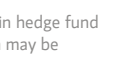
RISKS TO UPSIDE

- Faster than expected OCI capacity ramps
- Stronger than expected OCI gross margins
- Accelerated adoption of Fusion Apps and Cloud Database across the installed base
- Accelerated market share gains in non-AI Cloud

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

- Challenges in ramping OCI capacity
- Weaker than expect OCI gross margins
- GPUaaS capacity investments drive substantial leverage
- Disruptive technologies in the data management market

OWNERSHIP POSITIONING

Inst. Owners, % Active	49.5%	
HF Sector Long/Short Ratio	2.2x	
HF Sector Net Exposure	30.6%	

Refinitiv; MSPB Content. Includes certain hedge fund exposures held with MSPB. Information may be inconsistent with or may not reflect broader market trends. Long/Short Ratio = Long Exposure / Short exposure. Sector % of Total Net Exposure = (For a particular sector: Long Exposure - Short Exposure) / (Across all sectors: Long Exposure – Short Exposure).

MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY May 2027e

Sales / Revenue ($, mm)	89,098	90,423 / 90,450	91,688
EBITDA ($, mm)	46,105	54,209 / 52,854	61,917
Net income ($, mm)	23,663	24,270 / 24,711	25,424
EPS ($)	8.00	8.09 / 8.14	8.37

◆ Mean ◆ Morgan Stanley Estimates

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

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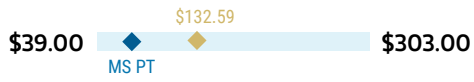
Risk Reward – CoreWeave (CRWV.O)

Building the GPU Economy

PRICE TARGET $70.00

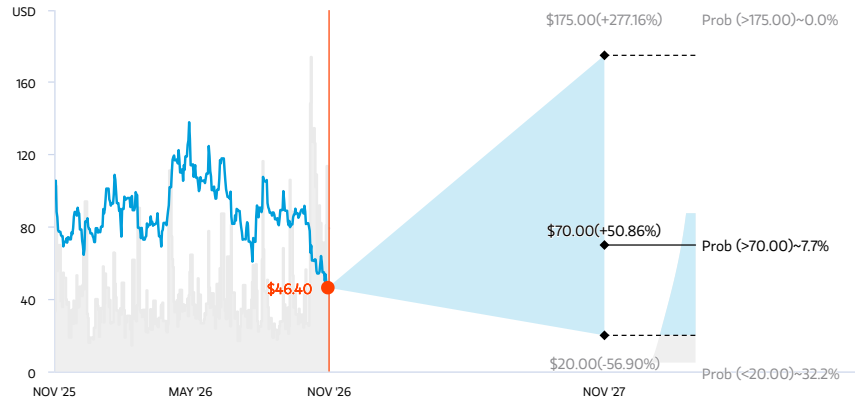
8x EV/CY30 uFCF of $20.4B (implies ~5x EV/CY27 Revenue or ~8x EV/CY27 EBITDA using CYE27 Net Debt, which is a discount to peers).

Consensus Price Target Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

RISK REWARD CHART AND OPTIONS IMPLIED PROBABILITIES (12M)



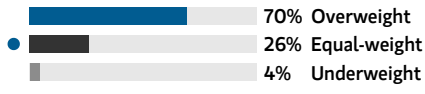
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EQUAL-WEIGHT THESIS

With a $361B GenAI Data Center opportunity ahead and the strong domain expertise in efficiently building and operating the GPU clusters, CoreWeave has built a >$100 billion book of business. This is balanced by a lack of meaningful operating and financial history and a high debt load. We see shares reasonably pricing a wide range of outcomes reflected in our base range.

Consensus Rating Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward Themes

Disruption: *Positive*

View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes here

BULL CASE

$175.00

10x CY30 EV/uFCF of $29.4B

Active power grows to 8.0 GW in CY30

Revenue grows to $137B in CY30, implying CY30 growth of 55%

Operating Margin of 27%

uFCF of $29.4B

BASE CASE RANGE

$50.00 - $115.00

7-8x CY30 EV/uFCF of $19.1-25.7B

Active power grows to a range of 5.1-6.7 GW in CY30

Revenue grows to $68-101B in CY30, implying CY30 growth of 36-47%

Operating Margin of 23-24%

uFCF of $19.1-$25.7B

BEAR CASE

$20.00

7x CY30 EV/uFCF of $9B

Active power grows to 2.5 GW in CY30

Revenue grows to $27B in CY30, implying CY30 growth of 18%

Operating Margin of 19%

uFCF of $9B

知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

Risk Reward – CoreWeave (CRWV.O)

KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	Dec 2025	Dec 2026e	Dec 2027e	Dec 2028e
Operating Margin (%)	13.0	8.3	16.1	22.6
Free Cash Flow Margin (%)	(141.3)	(233.8)	(133.7)	(67.8)

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

- Growth of the $360B GenAI data center opportunity
- Customer decisions to lease vs. own data centers
- Pricing stability in GPU instance pricing
- Useful life of GPU servers

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



- 0-10% APAC, ex Japan, Mainland China and India
- 0-10% Europe ex UK
- 0-10% India
- 0-10% Japan
- 0-10% Latin America
- 0-10% MEA
- 0-10% UK
- 80-90% North America

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies here

MS ALPHA MODELS

3/5 BEST	24 Month Horizon	4/5 MOST	3 Month Horizon

Source: Refinitiv, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research; 1 is the highest favored Quintile and 5 is the least favored Quintile

RISKS TO PT/RATING

RISKS TO UPSIDE

- Monetizable software
- Differentiation in inference
- Go-to-market progress and lower customer concentration
- Evidence of GPU monetization over six years

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

- Normalization in AI demand
- Trends of shortening useful life of AI servers in the industry
- Commentary from large customers around intentions to in-house AI compute in the future
- Difficulty in raising capital at an attractive or improving cost of debt

OWNERSHIP POSITIONING

Inst. Owners, % Active	55.4%
HF Sector Long/Short Ratio	2.2x
HF Sector Net Exposure	30.6%

Refinitiv; MSPB Content. Includes certain hedge fund exposures held with MSPB. Information may be inconsistent with or may not reflect broader market trends. Long/Short Ratio = Long Exposure / Short exposure. Sector % of Total Net Exposure = (For a particular sector: Long Exposure - Short Exposure) / (Across all sectors: Long Exposure – Short Exposure).

MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY Dec 2027e

Sales / Revenue ($, mm)	19,000	25,877 / 26,525	31,460
EBIT ($, mm)	2,412	4,178 / 4,140	5,955
EPS ($)	(5.41)	(0.46) / (2.05)	1.26

◆ Mean ◆ Morgan Stanley Estimates

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

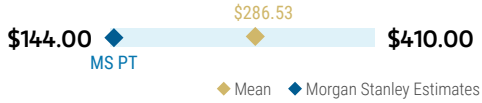
Risk Reward – Nebius Group NV (NBIS.O)

Differentiated Neocloud, Full Valuation

PRICE TARGET $144.00

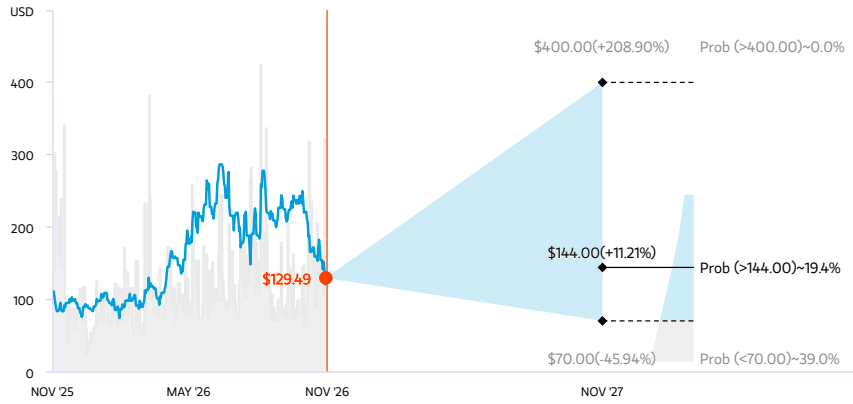
8x CY28 EBITDA $11.5B, using CYE 2028 net debt. 8x is a slight discount to the software average, though this is justified due to higher capital intensity.

Consensus Price Target Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

RISK REWARD CHART AND OPTIONS IMPLIED PROBABILITIES (12M)



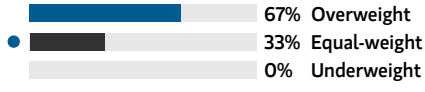
Key: Historical Stock Performance Current Stock Price Price Target

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research, Morgan Stanley Institutional Equities Division. The probabilities of our Bull, Base, and Bear case scenarios playing out were estimated with implied volatility data from the options market as of 6 Nov 2026. All figures are approximate risk-neutral probabilities of the stock reaching beyond the scenario price in either three-months' or one-years' time. View explanation of Options Probabilities methodology here

EQUAL-WEIGHT THESIS

Nebius' vertically integrated AI Cloud has won strong external validation and key reference customers.
We expect robust demand trends and execution bringing capacity online to drive ~$13bn ARR exiting 2028. Nebius strategy is focused: vertically integrated stack, selective in choosing quality large customers, sell to broad customer base, profitability matters. Solid balance sheet and access to capital, plus equity stakes in strategic assets, complement Nebius' lower TCO, which could drive higher margins and FCF LT. However, NT targets appear aggressive given significant net new bookings required; profitability and track-record are still unproven.

Consensus Rating Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward Themes

Secular Growth: *Positive*

View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes here

BULL CASE

$400.00

12x CY28 EBITDA of $13.9B

Nebius successfully brings online 5GW+ power by CY30, sells to broader customer base, benefits from higher margins due to lower TCO and better software monetization.

BASE CASE RANGE

$130.00 - $300.00

8.5x - 11x CY28 EBITDA $10.9B - $12.6B

Nebius continues making progress delivering capacity and selling that capacity to a broader customer base. Margins expand over-time as revenue ramps and workloads contribute steady-state margins

BEAR CASE

$70.00

7x CY28 EBITDA $10.4B

Economics suffer as demand and supply balance, competition from hyperscalers intensifies. Data center delivery proves harder than anticipated

知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

Risk Reward – Nebius Group NV (NBIS.O)

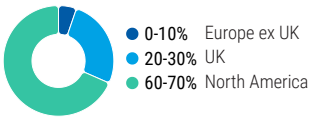
KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	Dec 2025	Dec 2026e	Dec 2027e	Dec 2028e
Revenue ($, mm)	530	3,389	10,926	19,059
Operating Margin (%)	(96.8)	(4.0)	8.9	9.3
Adjusted EBITDA Margin (%)	(12.2)	40.0	57.6	63.5

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

- New contracted power, connected power and delivery of active power
- New customer contracts / bookings
- Software innovation - new products, attach of software stack increasing
- Operating leverage with scale driving margins and FCF higher

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies here

MS ALPHA MODELS

4/5 BEST	24 Month Horizon	5/5 MOST	3 Month Horizon

Source: Refinitiv, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research; 1 is the highest favored Quintile and 5 is the least favored Quintile

RISKS TO PT/RATING

RISKS TO UPSIDE

- Further monetization of the full-stack (software)
- Addition/expansion of large customer contracts
- Evidence of GPU monetization beyond estimated four year useful life

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

- AI demand environment normalizes / Large customers in-house AI compute in the future
- Competition and macro/regulatory dynamics pressure pricing/returns
- Difficulty in raising capital at an attractive/improving cost of debt

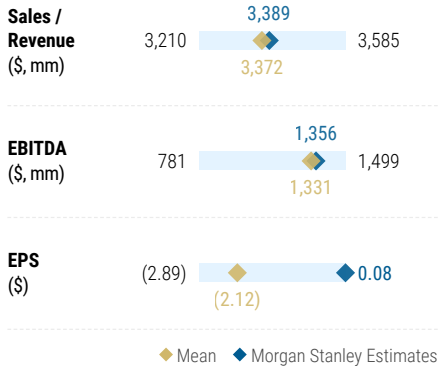
OWNERSHIP POSITIONING

Inst. Owners, % Active	61.3%
HF Sector Long/Short Ratio	2.2x
HF Sector Net Exposure	30.6%

Refinitiv; MSPB Content. Includes certain hedge fund exposures held with MSPB. Information may be inconsistent with or may not reflect broader market trends. Long/Short Ratio = Long Exposure / Short exposure. Sector % of Total Net Exposure = (For a particular sector: Long Exposure - Short Exposure) / (Across all sectors: Long Exposure – Short Exposure).

MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY Dec 2026e



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

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VX:FCCNN88

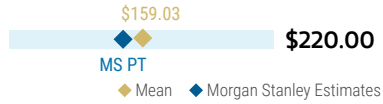
Risk Reward – DigitalOcean Holdings Inc (DOCN.N)

Robust Demand + Incremental Capacity + Strategic Position Drives Acceleration

PRICE TARGET $150.00

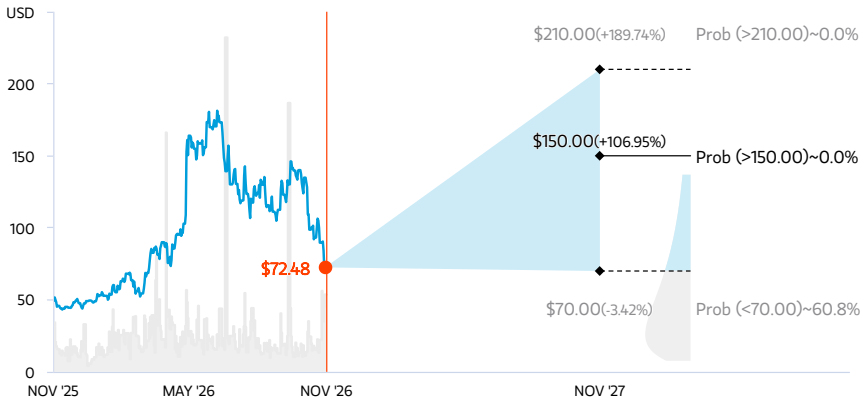
$150 PT is based on 17x $1,142MM CY28 EBITDA. 17x EBITDA is a modest premium to the current forward average multiple across software. This implies 7x CY28 sales, a modest premium to the SMID software group average.

Consensus Price Target Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

RISK REWARD CHART AND OPTIONS IMPLIED PROBABILITIES (12M)



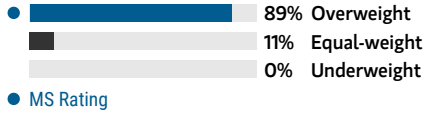
Key: Historical Stock Performance ● Current Stock Price ◆ Price Target

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OVERWEIGHT THESIS

DigitalOcean's AI strategy from day one has been to focus on Agentic and Inference workloads - as a result, its AI stack and Inference Cloud is well positioned to benefit from robust demand. As the company brings online more capacity, growth accelerates, attracting Digital Native Enterprises and larger customers with strong unit economics. Taking a small share in a large market can multiple DigitalOcean's business in the medium-term, a prospect not fully reflected in shares.

Consensus Rating Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward Themes

Pricing Power:	*Positive*
Secular Growth:	*Positive*

View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes here

BULL CASE $210.00

Pure Play Exposed to Strong Secular Trends

Rev grows to ~$3.1 billion in 2028. EBITDA margins reach 46% in 2028, driving 25% FCF margin. We apply an 18x EV/CY28 EBITDA multiple to reach our $210 bull case valuation, a warranted premium vs current forward average multiple across software. $210 implies 9x CY28 sales, a more meaningful premium to the SMID group average.

BASE CASE $150.00

Accelerating Growth Continues

Rev grows to ~$2.64 billion in 2028. EBITDA margins reach 43% in 2028, driving 22% FCF margin. We apply a 17x EV/CY28 EBITDA multiple to reach our $150 price target, a modest premium to the current forward average multiple across software to account for the growth profile. $150 implies 7x CY28 sales a modest premium to the SMID software group average.

BEAR CASE $70.00

Competition in Tougher Environment Weigh on Growth

Rev grows to ~$2.4 billion in 2028. EBITDA margins reach 42% in 2028, driving only 19% FCF margin. We apply a 9x EV/CY28 EBITDA multiple to reach our $70 bear case valuation, a warranted discount vs current forward average multiple across software. $70 implies 4x CY28 sales a discount to the SMID group average.

知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

Risk Reward – DigitalOcean Holdings Inc (DOCN.N)

KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	Dec 2025	Dec 2026e	Dec 2027e	Dec 2028e
Total Revenue Growth (%)	15.5	34.2	60.0	36.3
Total Customer Count Growth (%)	0.0	2.8	7.7	0.0
Dollar-based Net Retention Rate (%)	99.8	101.9	102.5	102.5
Operating Margin (%)	28.6	22.7	23.9	23.2
Free Cash Flow Margin (%)	18.6	21.0	22.0	22.0

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

1) New customer additions, 2) average monthly net ARPU, 3) dollar-based net expansion rate, 4) capex spend as % of revenue.

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



- 0-10% India
- 0-10% Japan
- 0-10% MEA
- 0-10% UK
- 10-20% APAC, ex Japan, Mainland China and India
- 20-30% Europe ex UK
- 30-40% North America

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies here

MS ALPHA MODELS

5/5 BEST	24 Month Horizon	3/5 MOST	3 Month Horizon

Source: Refinitiv, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research; 1 is the highest favored Quintile and 5 is the least favored Quintile

RISKS TO PT/RATING

RISKS TO UPSIDE

More Capacity. Higher GPU/CPU Pricing. Lower Churn / Increased Migration of Workloads from Other Clouds.

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

Competition. Supply & Demand for AI balance. Higher capital intensity weighs on cash flow and margins.

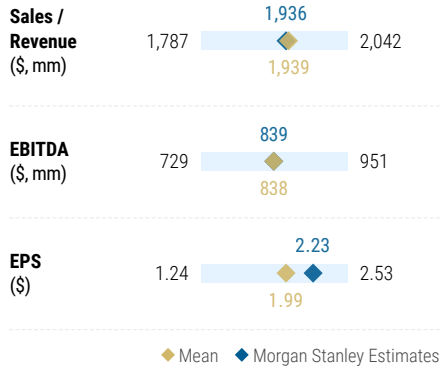
OWNERSHIP POSITIONING

Inst. Owners, % Active	61.4%
HF Sector Long/Short Ratio	2.2x
HF Sector Net Exposure	30.6%

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MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY Dec 2027e



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

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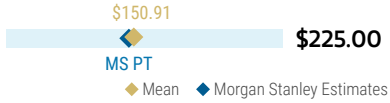
Risk Reward – Akamai Technologies, Inc. (AKAM.O)

Growth Prospects Brighten On Stable Security & an Accelerating Compute Business

PRICE TARGET $149.00

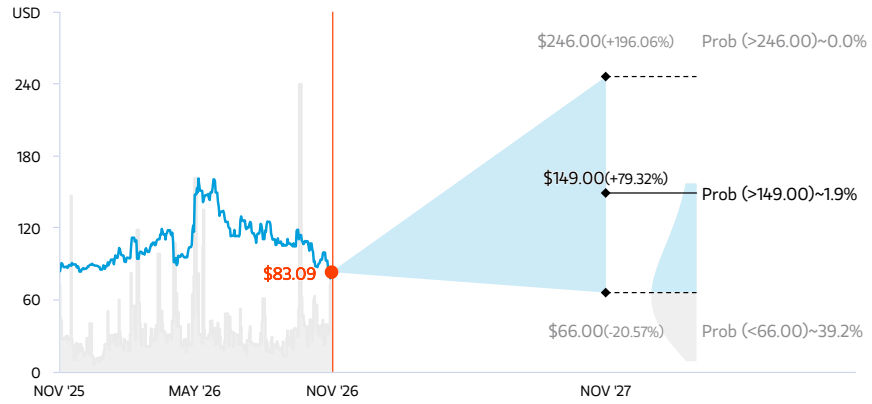
~16x Base Case CY28 EPS of $9.30. Given divergence between cloud infrastructure and security valuations and the lack of clean core comps, this is at a discount to company's closest valuation peer. EPS grows at a ~18% FY26-FY28 CAGR.

Consensus Price Target Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

RISK REWARD CHART AND OPTIONS IMPLIED PROBABILITIES (12M)



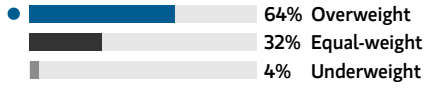
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OVERWEIGHT THESIS

Stabilizing trends in Delivery, high-single-digit growth in Security and accelerating CIS revenue lead us to believe Akamai is entering a multi-year growth inflection with a credible path to low-teens growth. While elevated investment creates near-term margin and EPS pressure, improving growth visibility and attractive long-term CIS economics support a more constructive view.

Consensus Rating Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward Themes

Contrarian:	*Positive*
Disruption:	*Positive*
Secular Growth:	*Positive*

View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes here

BULL CASE $246.00

25x Bull Case CY27e EPS of $9.83

Accelerating trends. Security momentum continues, CIS takes off with continued deal expansion as more AIC-enabled locations come online, driving ~$7.0B by FY28, a ~24% 2-year CAGR. Akamai continues to invest as leverage flows through the model and AKAM reaches $9.83 of EPS in CY27e, and the stock trades to 20x.

BASE CASE $149.00

16x Base Case CY27e EPS of $9.30

CIS Drives Growth. CIS drives Compute segment growth acceleration as security moderates at high-single-digits and delivery stabilizes in CY26. Total revenue grows at a ~22% two-year CAGR to $6.7B in FY28. Non-GAAP operating margins expand to 27%, resulting in $9.30 of CY27e EPS. Our $149 PT is based on ~16x CY27e EPS.

BEAR CASE $66.00

12x Bear Case CY27e EPS of $5.52

Revenue Lag Weighs on Margins and FCF. Investment ahead of contracted CIS deals pulls down FCF and revenue recognition mechanics weigh on margins. Media traffic decelerates while pricing remains a headwind and security continues to decelerate. AKAM achieves ~$5.3B of revenue and $5.52 of EPS in FY28e, while the stock trades to 13x EPS, in line with the low end of slow-growth software names.

知识星球：前沿信息收录
VX:FCCNN88

Risk Reward – Akamai Technologies, Inc. (AKAM.O)

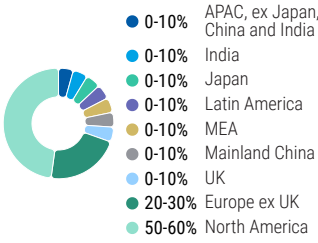
KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	Dec 2025	Dec 2026e	Dec 2027e	Dec 2028e
Web Division Revenue Growth - YoY (%)	7.4	8.1	21.1	35.6
Media and Carrier Division Revenue Growth - YoY (%)	3.2	3.8	16.2	30.2
Cloud Security Revenue Growth - YoY (%)	9.8	9.7	9.0	8.0
Total Revenue Growth - YoY (%)	5.4	6.1	18.9	33.2
Operating Margin (%)	29.8	25.1	22.2	26.2

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

Compute and Security businesses

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies here

MS ALPHA MODELS

2/5 BEST	24 Month Horizon	3/5 MOST	3 Month Horizon

Source: Refinitiv, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research; 1 is the highest favored Quintile and 5 is the least favored Quintile

RISKS TO PT/RATING

RISKS TO UPSIDE

- Security growth improves to the double digits
- Compute business accelerates to 20%+
- Traction with Akamai Inference Cloud improves growth and expands the multiple

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

- Delivery business sees steeper declines
- Security slows further
- Capex spending accelerates while compute growth doesn't improve
- Edge computing opportunity fails to materialize

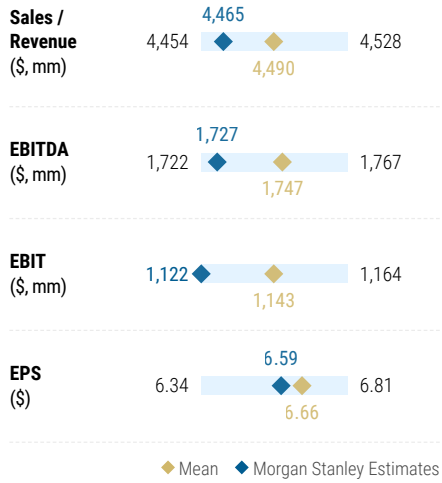
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MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY Dec 2026e



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

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Risk Reward Reference links

1. View explanation of Options Probabilities methodology - Options_Probabilities_Exhibit_Link.pdf

2. View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes - RR_Themes_Exhibit_Link.pdf

3. View explanation of regional hierarchies - GEG_Exhibit_Link.pdf

4. View explanation of Theme/Exposure methodology - ESG_Sustainable_Solutions_External_Link.pdf

5. View explanation of HERS methodology - ESG_HERS_External_Link.pdf

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Disclosure Section

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The following analysts hereby certify that their views about the companies and their securities discussed in this report are accurately expressed and that they have not received and will not receive direct or indirect compensation in exchange for expressing specific recommendations or views in this report: Ryan Lountzis; Sanjit K Singh; Adam Wood.

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(as of October 31, 2026)

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	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
Stock Rating Category	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1575	43%	460	49%	29%	742	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1537	42%	393	42%	26%	720	43%
Not-Rated/Hold	2	0%	1	0%	50%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	570	15%	92	10%	16%	218	13%
Total	3,684		946			1681	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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Overweight (O). The stock's total return is expected to exceed the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

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Unless otherwise specified, the time frame for price targets included in Morgan Stanley Research is 12 to 18 months.

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Attractive (A): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be attractive vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

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COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (11/06/2026)
Adam Wood		
Adobe Inc. (ADBE.O)	U (07/21/2026)	$239.30
Atlassian Corporation PLC (TEAM.O)	O (01/13/2020)	$153.68
CoreWeave (CRWV.O)	E (10/23/2026)	$46.40
Intuit (INTU.O)	E (07/21/2026)	$341.50
Microsoft (MSFT.O)	O (07/21/2026)	$530.61
Salesforce, Inc. (CRM.N)	E (07/21/2026)	$213.65
Samsara Inc (IOT.N)	E (03/23/2023)	$40.98
ServiceNow Inc (NOW.N)	O (09/24/2025)	$101.97
Shopify Inc (SHOP.O)	O (04/19/2024)	$148.91
Workday Inc (WDAY.O)	U (07/21/2026)	$192.90
Chris Quintero		
BILL Holdings Inc (BILL.N)	E (06/10/2025)	$52.41
Blackline Inc (BL.O)	E (07/21/2026)	$25.89
Box Inc (BOX.N)	E (05/21/2024)	$41.95
CCC Intelligent Solutions Holdings Inc (CCC.O)	++	$7.68
Descartes Systems Group Inc (DSGX.O)	O (01/15/2026)	$93.99
DocuSign Inc (DOCU.O)	E (01/16/2024)	$77.61
Manhattan Associates Inc. (MANH.O)	O (10/11/2026)	$252.78
Navan Inc (NAVN.O)	O (11/24/2025)	$25.48
ServiceTitan Inc (TTAN.O)	O (01/20/2026)	$81.77
SPS Commerce Inc (SPSC.O)	U (07/21/2026)	$81.91
Vertex Inc. (VERX.O)	E (07/21/2026)	$17.08
Via Transportation Inc (VIA.N)	O (01/20/2026)	$37.72
Elizabeth Porter, CFA		
Amplitude Inc. (AMPL.O)	O (01/15/2026)	$16.70
Asana Inc (ASAN.N)	U (05/20/2025)	$10.61
Autodesk (ADSK.O)	O (08/23/2024)	$261.72
Bandwidth Inc (BAND.O)	E (10/16/2026)	$40.34
Figma Inc (FIG.N)	E (08/25/2025)	$18.81
Five9 Inc (FIVN.O)	E (10/10/2022)	$28.12
Freshworks Inc (FRSH.O)	E (10/18/2021)	$12.11
GoDaddy Inc (GDDY.N)	E (07/19/2021)	$114.38
HubSpot, Inc. (HUBS.N)	E (11/05/2026)	$200.61
Klaviyo, Inc (KVYO.N)	O (04/29/2026)	$20.71
monday.com Ltd (MNDY.O)	O (08/12/2025)	$87.93
NICE Ltd. (NICE.O)	E (07/21/2026)	$96.15
Octave Intelligence Plc (OCTV.O)	E (09/17/2026)	$20.85
RingCentral Inc (RNG.N)	E (08/08/2023)	$72.07
Sprinklr Inc (CXM.N)	E (07/19/2021)	$6.67
Sprout Social Inc (SPT.O)	E (11/17/2020)	$11.06
Toast, Inc. (TOST.N)	O (12/16/2021)	$34.67
Twilio Inc (TWLO.N)	O (02/24/2025)	$202.02
Wix.Com Ltd (WIX.O)	E (07/21/2026)	$76.09
Zeta Global Holdings Corp (ZETA.N)	E (08/01/2024)	$31.03
Zoom Communications (ZM.O)	E (10/11/2022)	$89.88
ZoomInfo Technologies Inc (GTM.O)	E (02/01/2024)	$3.50
Meryl R Thomas, CFA		
Lightspeed Commerce Inc. (LSPD.N)	E (02/18/2021)	$10.29
Meta A Marshall		
Check Point Software Technologies Ltd. (CHKP.O)	E (10/16/2023)	$144.17

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CrowdStrike Holdings Inc (CRWD.O)	O (03/10/2026)	$216.90
Fortinet Inc. (FTNT.O)	E (07/21/2026)	$118.84
Gen Digital Inc. (GEN.O)	E (06/07/2024)	$29.79
Netskope, Inc. (NTSK.O)	O (10/13/2025)	$21.30
Okta, Inc. (OKTA.O)	O (12/02/2024)	$168.69
Palo Alto Networks Inc (PANW.O)	O (10/10/2017)	$313.84
Qualys Inc (QLYS.O)	U (02/09/2021)	$190.41
Rapid7 Inc (RPD.O)	U (07/21/2026)	$14.68
Rubrik Inc (RBRK.N)	O (10/29/2026)	$105.75
SailPoint Inc (SAIL.O)	O (09/02/2025)	$19.21
SentinelOne, Inc. (S.N)	E (12/02/2024)	$21.77
Tenable Holdings Inc (TENB.O)	E (12/02/2024)	$42.13
Varonis Systems, Inc. (VRNS.O)	++	$48.80
Zscaler Inc (ZS.O)	E (04/22/2026)	$197.66
Ryan Lountzis		
Nebius Group NV (NBIS.O)	E (01/15/2026)	$129.49
Sanjit K Singh		
Akamai Technologies, Inc. (AKAM.O)	O (01/12/2026)	$83.09
Appian Corp (APPN.O)	E (04/30/2026)	$51.60
C3.ai (AI.N)	U (01/04/2021)	$11.69
Cloudflare Inc (NET.N)	O (12/02/2024)	$268.75
Datadog, Inc. (DDOG.O)	O (01/12/2026)	$179.04
DigitalOcean Holdings Inc (DOCN.N)	O (01/16/2025)	$72.48
Dynatrace Inc (DT.N)	O (08/25/2026)	$43.44
Elastic NV (ESTC.N)	E (07/21/2026)	$86.08
GitLab Inc (GTLB.O)	E (01/12/2026)	$48.09
JFrog Ltd. (FROG.O)	E (07/21/2026)	$100.98
MongoDB Inc (MDB.O)	O (04/12/2023)	$312.83
Oracle Corporation (ORCL.N)	E (01/15/2019)	$116.10
PagerDuty, Inc. (PD.N)	U (07/21/2026)	$15.68
Palantir Technologies Inc. (PLTR.O)	E (02/04/2025)	$160.38
Snowflake Inc. (SNOW.N)	O (06/24/2025)	$275.88
UiPath Inc (PATH.N)	E (09/07/2022)	$13.00

Stock Ratings are subject to change. Please see latest research for each company.
* Historical prices are not split adjusted.

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